Santa Clara

Washington County, Utah · 89 published facts from 44 documents

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Every line below was taken from a document somebody can read, and the documents are listed at the end with a link to each. Where a figure could not be traced to one, it is not here: the research holds more numbers than we publish. Nothing on this sheet is a price or a promise about how fast we arrive.

Water

- Santa Clara's 2025 water quality report (2024 data) shows total dissolved solids ranging from 136 to 552 ppm.
- Santa Clara's 2024 data shows sulfate ranging from 1.38 to 209 ppm.
- Santa Clara's 2024 data shows sodium ranging from 9 to 55 ppm.
- Santa Clara's 2024 data shows arsenic samples from 1.0 to 13.0 ppb with a running annual average of 8.68 ppb, below the 10 ppb federal maximum contaminant level but with little headroom.
- Santa Clara's arsenic running annual average of 8.68 ppb matches St. George's, and both systems operate close to the 10 ppb limit.
- Santa Clara's 2024 data shows fluoride of 0.2 to 0.512 ppm and nitrate-nitrogen from not-detected to 3.0 ppm.
- Santa Clara's 2024 data shows combined radium 226/228 of 0.6 to 1.6 pCi/L.
- Santa Clara's 2024 data shows total trihalomethanes of 26.52 to 33.94 ppb and HAA5 of 3.46 to 6.848 ppb; the TTHM figure is under the 80 ppb federal limit.
- Santa Clara's report does not state calcium, magnesium, uranium, or the disinfectant used.
- Disinfection byproducts (TTHM and HAA5) are the most consistently elevated contaminant group across Washington County systems because the dominant source is chlorinated Virgin River surface water.
- A water softener does not remove arsenic; cation exchange has no effect on it.
- The federal arsenic limit of 10 ppb was adopted January 22, 2001 with compliance required by January 23, 2006.
- Point-of-use reverse osmosis rejects 95 to 99 percent of dissolved solids and is the appropriate tool for a homeowner who wants margin below the arsenic limit rather than bare compliance.

The ground

- In January 2005 a flood on the Santa Clara River washed away about 20 homes and damaged another 10 beyond repair, roughly 30 structures lost, according to a university teaching case study on the flood.
- The 2005 flood was driven by a weak El Niño that steered a southerly Pacific storm track over existing snowpack.
- During the 2005 flood the Santa Clara River widened to a hundred yards in places.
- The 2005 flood's discharge was less than the expected 100-year flood; the destruction happened at below 100-year flow.
- Most homes destroyed in 2005 sat above the 100-year floodplain, leaving their owners without flood insurance, according to a university teaching case study on the flood.
- The 2005 damage mechanism was stream bank erosion from meander migration, not inundation.
- The documented lesson of the 2005 flood is that analyzing risk along streams requires knowledge of both flood and stream-bank erosion hazards.
- Washington County publishes three separate flood-related GIS layers, FEMA Flood Hazard (layer 0), Erosion Hazard Boundary (layer 3), and Flood Hazard Based on Geologic Deposits (layer 4), because FEMA's map alone is insufficient here.
- Washington County also maps dam-break inundation areas (GIS layers 5 to 7) downstream of Quail Creek and Sand Hollow reservoirs.
- The Utah Geological Survey calls flooding the most widespread and damaging geologic hazard in southwestern Utah.
- Expansive blue clay of the Chinle Formation's Petrified Forest Member has caused documented damage to homes in the Santa Clara area.
- The Utah Geological Survey illustrates expansive soil damage with a photograph of cracks in a Santa Clara house foundation.
- The Utah Geological Survey calls expansive soil and rock the most troublesome construction condition in the St. George area.
- The blue clay's mineralogy is illite/smectite, an expandable clay that absorbs water and swells; it occurs in an arc across the St. George area and dips deeper below the surface toward the north.
- Utah Geological Survey Special Study 127 maps geologic hazards and adverse construction conditions across 366 square miles including Santa Clara, at 1:24,000 scale.
- The Utah Geological Survey defines collapsible soil as soil with considerable strength when dry that settles significantly by hydrocompaction when wetted, typically in young alluvial fans and debris flows.
- Washington County publishes 24 free public hazard map layers, and the Utah Geologic Hazards Portal offers a second free lookup.
- The EPA maps Washington County as Radon Zone 2, the middle of its three categories, meaning a predicted average indoor screening level between 2 and 4 picocuries per liter. The action level is 4, and a zone map is a geological prediction that does not describe any individual house.

- The 1992 St. George earthquake was magnitude 5.8 on September 2, 1992, and Special Study 127 says the Hurricane fault is capable of earthquakes as large as magnitude 6.5 to 7.

Rebates and the easement

- The WCWCD Water Efficient Landscape rebate pays $3 per square foot on the first 1,000 square feet of lawn removed and $2 per square foot after that, for projects completed before June 1, 2027.
- WCWCD's smart-controller rebate of up to $100 and toilet-replacement rebate of up to $150 (up to 2 toilets, manufactured before 1994) are separate applications and can be claimed alongside a landscape conversion.
- The Washington County Water Conservancy District caps the landscape rebate at $100,000 per property per calendar year. There is no five-year waiting rule on the district side; that limit belongs to the separate state program, which Washington County applicants are routed away from.
- Demolishing the lawn before receiving WCWCD's written approval email and a pre-conversion site visit permanently voids rebate eligibility.
- Living grass must be present at the WCWCD inspection; irrigation may be shut off for up to a month beforehand as long as grass blades remain visible, but the grass may not be removed.
- WCWCD requires the converted area to have 50 percent living plant and tree cover at maturity and assigns each tree 350 square feet of cover and each shrub or perennial 35 square feet; existing trees inside the conversion count.
- WCWCD does not dictate plant species for the rebate and publishes no approved plant list; it requires only 50 percent mature coverage.
- Every rebated conversion attaches a perpetual conservation easement, recorded with the Washington County Recorder, that forever prohibits irrigated grass, spray irrigation, pools, ponds, and water features in the converted area only.
- WCWCD enforces the easement by aerial imagery; a violation brings written notice, 45 days to cure, then repayment of the full rebate plus administrative costs plus 5 percent annual interest.
- Release of the easement is discretionary with WCWCD, must be written and recorded, and the price is repayment of the full rebate plus administrative costs and 5 percent per year interest; the easement must be granted before the incentive is issued.
- Ungrouted pavers and dry-set flagstone count as mulch inside a rebated area, while poured concrete and mortared work are subtracted from the incentive calculation.
- WCWCD accepts permeable artificial turf only in lieu of mulch as a component of a conversion; it does not rebate an artificial-turf lawn.
- WCWCD pays landscape rebates within 60 days of project completion and paperwork submission.
- WCWCD says a typical contractor conversion costs $4 to $6 per square foot, rebates commonly cover 30 to 50 percent of the cost, and a typical residential conversion saves up to $300 a year in water.
- WCWCD does not require a W-9 or issue a 1099 for owner-occupied primary residences; secondary residences, rentals, and commercial properties are issued a 1099, which matters in a short-term-rental pocket.

- Plastic weed barriers are not permitted in a rebated conversion; any barrier used must be permeable, and WCWCD says a few inches of mulch usually suppresses weeds adequately.
- Under Utah Code 57-8a-218(15), an HOA where owners maintain their own landscaping must adopt rules supporting water-wise landscaping and may not prohibit conversion of a grass park strip to water-efficient landscaping.
- If an HOA compels a homeowner to keep grass, WCWCD invites the homeowner to email conservation@wcwcd.org and will take reasonable steps to inform the HOA of applicable state and local law, though HOAs may still enforce design standards.

Associations

- At Entrada at Snow Canyon, all exterior changes need Entrada Design Review Committee approval, including paint, landscaping, stone, barbecue, spa, solar, and landscape lighting.
- The Entrada Design Review Committee meets the first and third Thursday of each month at 9 a.m., and submissions are due the prior Thursday.
- Entrada has eight gates and a manned gatehouse; gate fobs cost $30 each (one per garage bay), pedestrian keys $15, and guest access runs through the MyQ app.
- Entrada is not one association: the Entrada Property Owners Association covers 13 subdivisions, while The Cliffs of Snow Canyon, Lava Cove POA, and Lava Falls are separate associations with different managers.
- The Cliffs of Snow Canyon is managed by Paul Properties.
- The Entrada Property Owners Association is managed by PMP Management.
- Bella Sol at Santa Clara Association is listed as a supporter of the Utah Chapter of Community Associations Institute's Association Drought Compact, a public pledge list with no stated obligations.
- Under Utah Code 57-8a-231, an HOA may not require a lot owner to install or keep lawn or turf in an area less than eight feet wide, except where reasonably necessary for erosion control.
- Under Utah Code 57-8a-231(2), an HOA may not prohibit a lot owner of a detached dwelling from incorporating water-wise landscaping, though it may still require site-plan review and its own water-wise design standards.
- Under Utah Code 57-8a-109(4), an HOA denial must state in writing each governing-document provision relied on and the specific aspect of the plan that does not conform, and under 57-8a-109(2) a plan fee may not exceed the actual cost of review.
- Under Utah Code 57-8a-212(4), effective May 6, 2026, an HOA declaration may not restrict the interior of a dwelling except as reasonably necessary for the safety of adjacent lots, and may not bar an owner from hiring a contractor solely because the contractor is not on the association's preferred vendor list.
- Under Utah Code 57-8a-802, an HOA may not prohibit a lot owner from installing an EV charging system on the owner's lot or in a limited common area parking space designated for the owner's exclusive use, though it may require an application and a licensed electrical contractor.

City and county rules

- Santa Clara adopted its own water ordinance in February 2022 that limits lawn sizes and the types of plants that may be installed.
- Snow Canyon State Park's December 2025 dark-sky designation directly affects Santa Clara, one of the two submarkets where lighting rules bite hardest.
- Utah adopts construction code statewide under Title 15A, so the plumbing code in Santa Clara is the same as in neighboring cities; what varies is permit triggers, fees, process, irrigation rules, and lighting.
- Utah H.B. 215 (2026) amended Utah Code 10-20-619 so that a municipality may not require a property owner to install or keep lawn or turf in an area less than eight feet wide, and may not block vegetation removal required for defensible space under the Wildland Urban Interface Code.
- Utah H.B. 48 took effect January 1, 2026 and requires each municipality to adopt and enforce the Utah Wildland Urban Interface Code for its incorporated area.
- WCWCD's Water Efficiency Standards (October 2023) require that all non-lawn plant material be irrigated by drip with a pressure regulator, filter, flush-end assembly, and emitters rated 20 gallons per hour or less, and that drip and spray never share a valve.
- WCWCD's Water Efficiency Standards apply to landscape installation, not just new construction, and where they conflict with a city ordinance or HOA requirement the regulation providing the greatest water conservation benefit applies.
- WCWCD's Water Efficiency Standards cap single-family lawn at 8 percent of the lot or 2,500 square feet, whichever is less, allow up to 600 square feet on lots under 7,500 square feet, bar lawn narrower than 8 feet in any dimension, and bar lawn on slopes over 25 percent.
- WCWCD's Water Efficiency Standards limit ornamental water features to 25 square feet per parcel.

Climate

- WCWCD advises that neighborhoods at low elevations near rivers and drainages are cooler because cold air settles at the lowest points, so marginally hardy plants are more likely to freeze there.
- WCWCD states that several zone 9 plants have grown in popularity locally but homeowners planting them are taking a risk.
- Most of Washington County falls in Sunset climate zone 10, with hot summers, cold winters, up to 300 growing days a year, and elevations from 3,300 to 5,000 feet.
- Snow Canyon State Park received International Dark Sky designation in December 2025, which directly affects lighting expectations in Santa Clara.
- Southwest Utah has a defined monsoon season that generates flash flooding, with abrupt transitions from long dry spells; St. George recorded a 78-day dry spell that ended with monsoon onset in one recent year.
- The nearby St. George station recorded an all-time high of 117°F, set in July 1985 and matched on July 11, 2021, 98 days at or above 100°F in 2024, and an all-time low of –11°F on January 26, 1937.

- Penn State's Center for Sports Surface Research measured synthetic turf at 200°F on a 98°F day in Provo, Utah, and found that 30 minutes of watering dropped turf from 174°F to 85°F only for it to rebound to 120°F within 5 minutes.
- WCWCD states that shade keeps areas up to 25 degrees cooler, shade trees can lower surface temperatures by up to 50 degrees, and grass uses four times more water than trees and shrubs.

Utilities

- Santa Clara operates its own culinary water system and publishes an annual Consumer Confidence Report at santaclarautah.gov.
- The Washington County Water Conservancy District's Quail Creek Water Treatment Plant and Sand Hollow Wells regional system supplies Santa Clara, alongside St. George, Washington, Hurricane, and Ivins.
- More than 80 percent of the drinking water the Washington County Water Conservancy District delivers is Virgin River surface water stored in Sand Hollow and Quail Creek reservoirs; the rest is Navajo aquifer groundwater.
- Santa Clara is served by its own municipal power department, not Rocky Mountain Power.
- Santa Clara's building permit fee schedule effective January 2026 lists an underground electrical connection up to 200 amps at $758.00 and a minimum building inspection fee of $56.00; the city's number is (435) 656-4690.
- In the 2025 reporting year the St. George City secondary irrigation system purchased 3,119.69 acre-feet from the Santa Clara Project and 1,245.41 acre-feet from the New Santa Clara Field Canal.
- The Washington County Water Conservancy District residential water impact fee is $13,500.

Housing

- The Entrada Property Owners Association covers 13 subdivisions, with The Cliffs of Snow Canyon, Lava Cove, and Lava Falls organized as separate associations.
- Washington County had 91,460 housing units as of July 2025, 69,786 households, 71.6 percent owner-occupied, a median home value of $510,700, a population of 213,670, and 2,857 building permits in 2025.
- The EPA Renovation, Repair and Painting Rule applies to homes built before 1978 and requires contractors to be trained and certified in lead-safe work practices; it has no small-residential exemption.

Where every line above came from

44 documents, each opened and read. Every title is a live link in this file. The number in front of it is how many of the facts above sit in the research section that cites it — it is a reading list, not a claim that one sentence appears in one paper.

16 2025 Consumer Confidence Report (2024 data) — Santa Clara City (PDF)
16 Utah flood hazards — Utah Division of Emergency Management (map)
14 Incentives — Washington County Water Conservancy District
11 Problem soils — Utah Geological Survey

11 Special Study 127, geologic hazards of the St. George area — Utah Geological Survey (PDF)
11 State Hazard Mitigation Plan, chapter 8, geologic hazards — Utah Division of Emergency Management (PDF)
10 Geologic hazard map of the St. George area — Utah Geological Survey
10 Hazards map service, Expansive Rock and Soil layer — Washington County (map)
9 Water Conservation Easement, 2019 trustee form — Washington County Water Conservancy District (PDF)
9 Water quality — Washington County Water Conservancy District
8 Active faults, Hurricane fault documentation — Utah Geological Survey (PDF)
8 Circular 122, guidelines for investigating geologic hazards and preparing engineering-geology reports — Utah Geological Survey (PDF)
8 Geologic Hazards Model Ordinance, 2020 — Five County Association of Governments (PDF)
8 Hazards map service — Washington County (map)
8 Hazards map service, Collapsible Soils layer — Washington County (map)
8 Landscape Incentive Program details — Utah Water Savers, Utah Division of Water Resources
8 Landscape Incentives Requirements, May 2023 — Utah Division of Water Resources (PDF)
8 Salt Lake City forecast office, which covers southwest Utah — National Weather Service
8 St. George climate station GHCND:USC00427516 — NOAA National Centers for Environmental Information
8 Utah Geologic Hazards Portal — Utah Geological Survey (map)
8 Water Efficiency Standards, October 2023 — Washington County Water Conservancy District (PDF)
7 Guide to selecting concrete exposure classes, ACI and NRMCA — National Ready Mixed Concrete Association (PDF)
7 H.B. 48, 2025 — Utah Legislature (PDF)
7 Hazards map service, Gypsiferous Rock and Soil layer — Washington County (map)
7 Ultraviolet radiation exposure, technical bulletin PI-TB-004 — Westlake Pipe and Fittings (PDF)
7 Urban heat, February 2025 — Washington County Water Conservancy District (PDF)
6 H.B. 215, 2026, Landscaping Restrictions Amendments — Utah Legislature (PDF)
6 Landscape rebates — Utah Division of Water Resources
6 Program eligibility — Utah Water Savers, Utah Division of Water Resources
6 Water-wise policies and programs in Utah — Utah State University Extension
3 Drinking water arsenic rule history — U.S. Environmental Protection Agency
3 Public water system records — Utah Division of Water Rights
3 S.B. 122, 2026 — Utah Legislature (PDF)
3 Utah Code Title 57 Chapter 8, Condominium Ownership Act — Utah Legislature (PDF)
3 Utah Code Title 57 Chapter 8a, Community Association Act — Utah Legislature (PDF)
2 Property search — Washington County Recorder
2 Recorder's fee schedule — Washington County
1 Limited gas tankless water heater warranty — A. O. Smith (PDF)
1 Limited warranty, tankless water heaters — Noritz (PDF)
1 NPE-A series warranty — Navien
1 NPN-U series warranty — Navien
1 RTGH gas tankless warranty guide — Rheem (PDF)
1 Tank water heater warranty 238-45005-00 — Bradford White (PDF)
1 Utah Code Title 58 Chapter 55 Part 5, prohibited conduct for contractors — Utah Legislature (PDF)

Check us before you book us.

Heating and air conditioning: Utah DOPL license 14276430-5501. Look it up on the state's public lookup. For any other trade, ask for the license number before anyone comes out and check it the same way. The full research, and this town's facts kept current, is at https://stgeorgehomeservices.com/research

https://secure.utah.gov/llv/search/index.html